

Gryphmark

Write Markdown visually. See it like GitHub.

User Manual · v1.7.0

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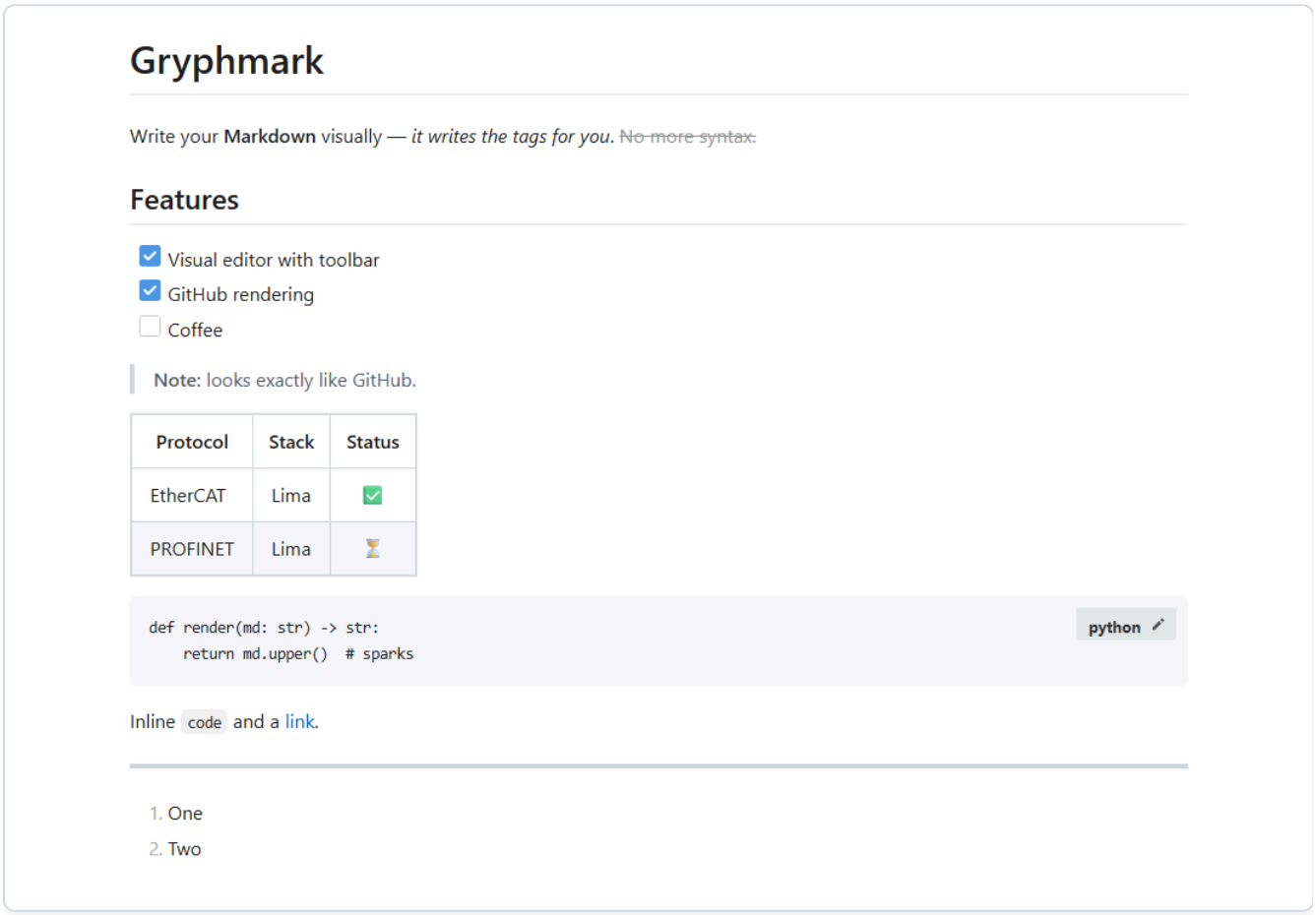
Contents

1. What is Gryphmark
2. Installation
3. The window
4. Three ways to see a document
5. Folders: the Files panel
6. Formatting toolbar
7. Files
8. Export and print
9. Working tools
10. Language, theme and zoom
11. Keyboard shortcuts
12. Technical information

1. What is Gryphmark

Gryphmark is a Markdown viewer and editor for Windows. You format text with buttons — headings, bold, lists, tables, code — and Gryphmark writes the Markdown tags behind the scenes. Every document is shown exactly the way GitHub displays it, in light or dark theme.

It is designed for `README.md` files, notes, documentation and any `.md` file you want to read or edit without memorising syntax.



Visual editor: format with the toolbar, no tags in sight.

2. Installation

Run `Gryphmark-Setup-1.7.0.exe`. The installer is available in English and Spanish and does **not** need administrator rights: it installs for the current user in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Gryphmark`.

Option	What it does
Desktop shortcut	Adds a Gryphmark icon to the desktop.
Open .md files with Gryphmark	Adds Gryphmark to *Open with* for .md / .markdown files, and makes it the handler for those files for the current user.
Add "Open with Gryphmark" to folders	Right-click a folder (or the empty space inside one) in Explorer to open it in the Files panel. In Windows 11 it is under *Show more options*.

Requirements: Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit) and Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, which is already part of Windows 11. The .NET runtime is included; nothing else has to be installed.

Up to version 1.1.1 the program was called **Quillforge**. If that version is installed, the installer removes it, and Gryphmark copies its settings, recent files and recovery drafts on the first start.

To uninstall: *Settings → Apps → Installed apps → Gryphmark → Uninstall*. Your settings in `%APPDATA%\Gryphmark` are kept.

3. The window

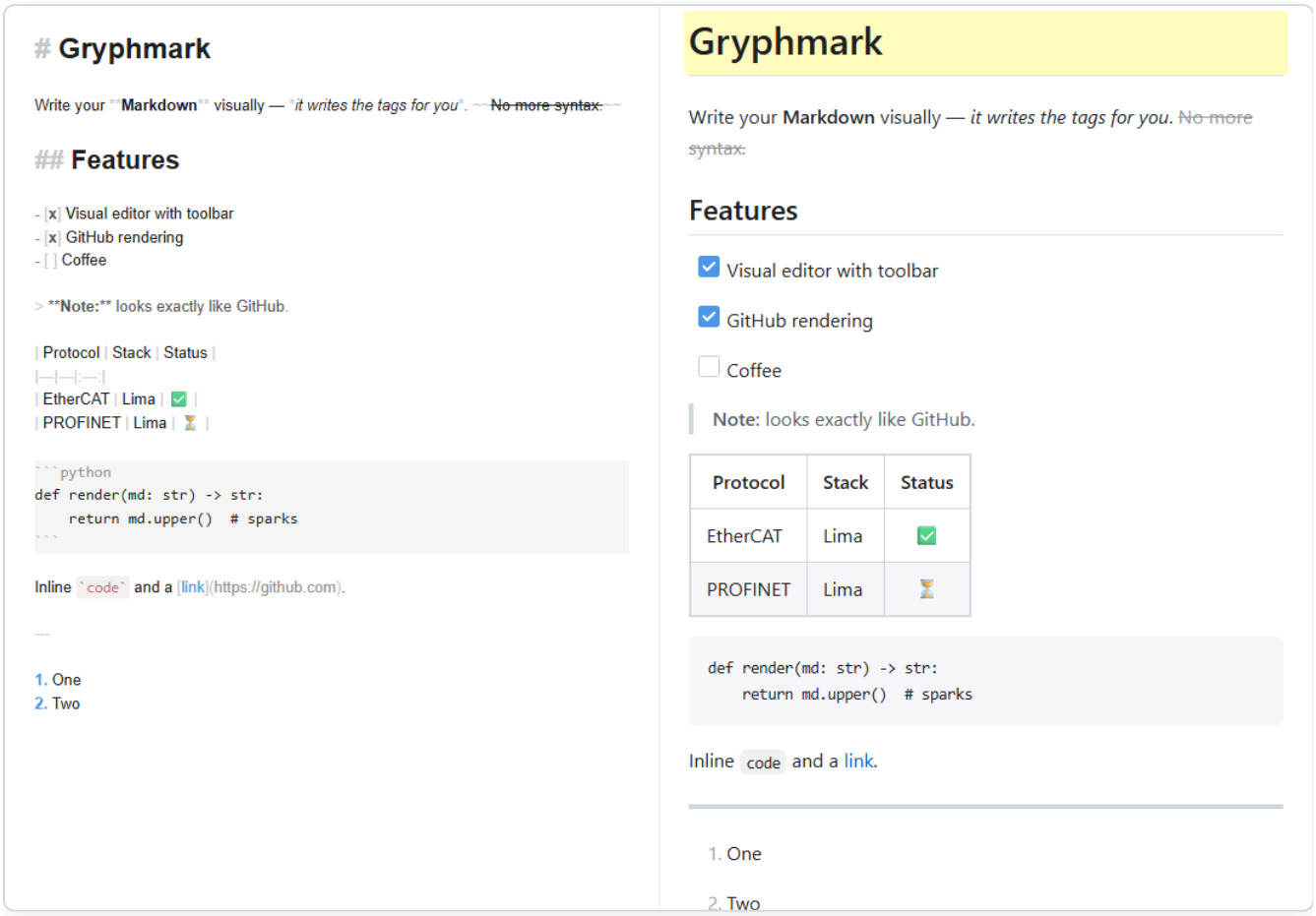
Part	Use
Menu bar	File, Edit, Format, View, Language and Help. All menus are available in English and Spanish.
Toolbar	The formatting buttons (see below). Hidden in GitHub preview, which is read-only.
Document	The page itself, laid out with the same column width, fonts and spacing as github.com.
Status bar	File path, word count, current mode, and whether there are unsaved changes.

The title bar shows the file name; a ● in front of it means there are unsaved changes.

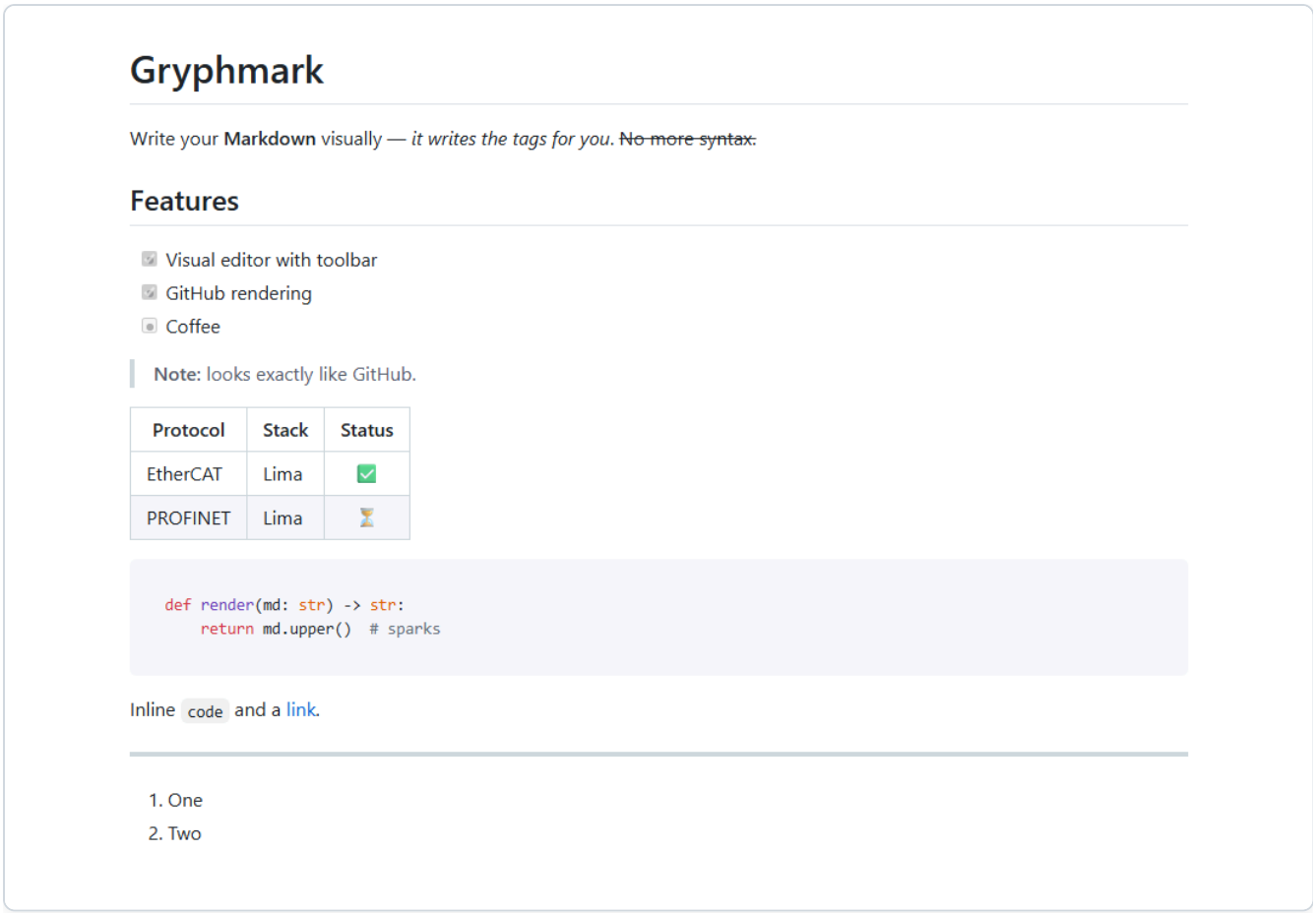
4. Three ways to see a document

Switch with the three buttons at the right end of the toolbar — **Visual · Markdown · GitHub** —, the *View* menu or the shortcuts. Hover over a button to see what it does.

Button	Shortcut	What you see
Visual Visual editor	`Ctrl` + `1`	The formatted document. Type and use the buttons; the Markdown is generated for you.
Markdown Markdown source	`Ctrl` + `2`	The raw Markdown on the left and a live preview on the right. For when you want to see or touch the tags.
GitHub GitHub preview	`Ctrl` + `3`	Read-only page rendered like GitHub, with syntax highlighting, task lists and clickable links.



Markdown source with live preview.



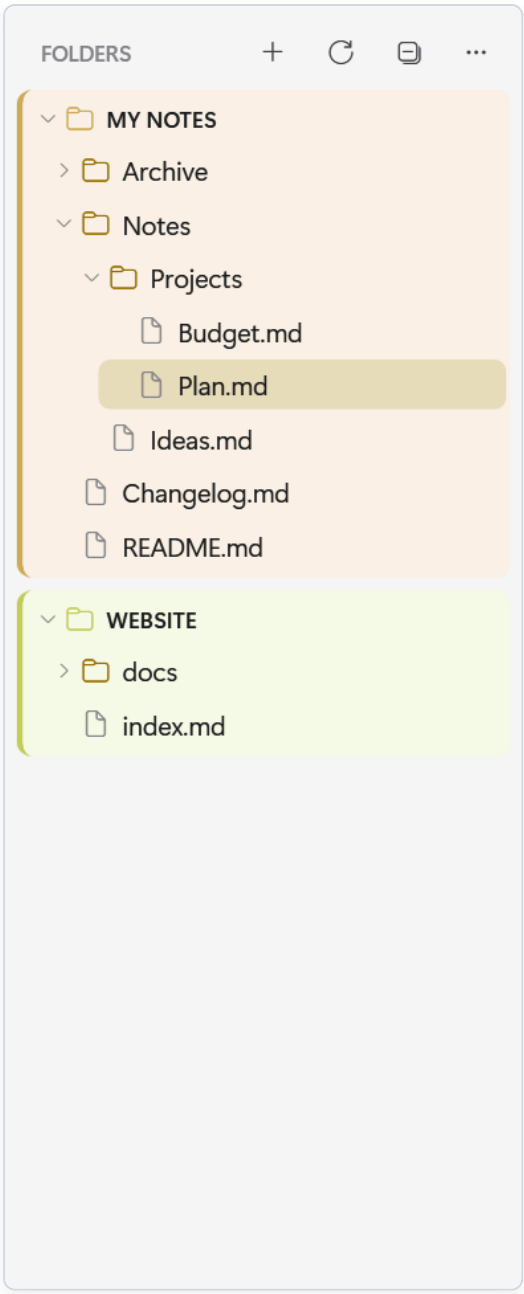
GitHub preview (light theme).

Read only

When you only want to read a document, choose **Read only** in the **Edit | Read only** switch, to the left of the view buttons (also *View → Read only* or `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `L`). The text is locked in every view: keys, paste, drag and drop and the task boxes do nothing, and the formatting buttons are greyed out. You can still read, select, copy, find and switch views. If you type, the status bar reminds you how to unlock it. Choose **Edit** to write again; Gryphmark remembers your choice.

5. Folders: the Files panel

Like VS Code or Obsidian, Gryphmark shows folders as trees on the left: subfolders and Markdown files (`.md`, `.markdown`). You can have **several folders open at once**; each one is a block with its own pastel colour and a stripe on its left edge, so you see at a glance where one tree ends and the next begins. Click a file and it opens beside the trees.



Two folders open; the open file is marked.

Action	How
Open a folder	The **+** button of the panel, *File → Open folder…*, the **Open folder…** button of the empty panel, dropping a folder on the window, or right-clicking a folder in Explorer → *Open with Gryphmark* (installer option; in Windows 11 it is under *Show more options*). Each new folder is added below the others.
Show / hide the panel	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `E`, the folder button at the left of the toolbar, or *View → Files panel*. Drag its right edge to make it wider.
Browse	Click a folder to open or close it; click a file to open it. `Enter` does the same on the selected row.
Right-click a folder's title	**Pin to top** / **Unpin**, **Close this folder**, **Colour** (twelve pastel colours or *Automatic*), **Move up** / **Move down** (in opening order), show in folder, copy path, refresh.
Right-click inside a tree	On a file: open, open in a new window, show in folder, copy path. On a folder: show in folder, copy path, refresh.
Panel buttons	**+** add folder, refresh, collapse all, and **…**: the order, the colours and what opens at start.

Order, colours and pins

The **…** button of the panel sorts the folders: *Order opened* (the default), *Name A → Z*, *Name Z → A* or *Recently modified first*. **Pinned** folders (📌) always stay on top, in the order you pinned them. Colours: *Tones of the theme colour* (the default: shades of the colour chosen in *View → Theme…*), *Multicolour* (a different hue for each folder) or *No colour*; a single folder can get its own colour from its right-click menu.

Dedicated instances

Some files or folders deserve a Gryphmark of their own — a to-do list, a wiki — so they never get mixed with your other work. Right-click a file, or the title of a folder, and choose **Open in a dedicated instance**, or **Desktop shortcut (dedicated instance)** to get a shortcut that always opens it that way. A dedicated instance is a separate window with its own settings, open folders, recent files and size; its name is shown in the title bar. Opening it again brings that window to the front instead of starting another one. It starts with the language, theme and colour of the main window. (Technically: `Gryphmark.exe --profile "Name" "path"`; its settings live in `%APPDATA%\Gryphmark\profiles\Name`.)

Open in a new window is different: it is an extra window of the main Gryphmark. It can be used freely, and it never writes over the main window's open folders or size.

What opens when Gryphmark starts

Choose it in *File → Folders at start* or in the **…** button of the panel:

Option	What happens
Reopen the folders of the last session	The panel comes back exactly as you left it (the default).
Start clean, with no folders	Every start begins with an empty panel.
Start clean, only with the pinned folders	Every start shows just the folders you pinned — for example the one or two projects you always work on.

The panel follows the disk: files and folders created, renamed or deleted by other programs (for example in Explorer) appear or disappear at once. If a whole open folder is deleted, or a network drive goes away, its block stays with the note *not available* and comes back by itself when the folder does; clicking a file that was deleted meanwhile just refreshes the panel. Hidden folders and tool folders (`.git`, `node_modules`, `bin`, `obj` …) are left out. Recent folders are listed in *File → Open recent*.

6. Formatting toolbar

Button	Action	Markdown it writes
H	Heading 1–6 or normal paragraph	`# Title` … `###### Title`
B	Bold	`**text**`
I	Italic	`*text*`
~~S~~	Strikethrough	`~~text~~`
—	Horizontal rule	`***`
❝	Quote	`> text`
• list / 1. list	Bulleted / numbered list	`- item` / `1. item`
☑	Task list	`- [ ] task`
→ / ←	Indent / outdent list item	nested list
Table	Insert table (choose rows × columns)	`| a | b |`
Image	Insert image from URL or file name	`![alt](file.png)`
Link	Insert link	`[text](https://…)`
</>	Inline code	`` `code` ``
CB	Code block (choose language for colouring)	```` ```python ````

The same actions are in the **Format** menu. Right-click inside a table to add or delete rows and columns, or to align a column.

7. Files

Action	How
Open	*File* → *Open* (`Ctrl`+`O`), double-click a .md file, or drag a file onto the window.
Recent files	*File* → *Open recent* keeps the last 12 files.
Save / Save as	`Ctrl`+`S` / `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`S`. New files are saved as UTF-8 without BOM, the same as GitHub; existing files keep their encoding and line endings.
New / New window	`Ctrl`+`N` starts an empty document; *New window* opens a second Gryphmark.
Show in folder	Opens Explorer with the file selected.

If you close a document with unsaved changes, Gryphmark asks whether to save them.

Images and links

Relative paths work as on GitHub: `![diagram](img/diagram.png)` shows the image stored next to the .md file. In GitHub preview, links to web pages open in your browser, links to other `.md` files open in Gryphmark, and `#heading` links jump inside the document.

8. Export and print

Export to HTML saves a single, self-contained HTML page with the GitHub style embedded — ready to e-mail or publish.

Print / PDF (`Ctrl`+`P`) prints the GitHub-style page. Choose *Save as PDF* as the printer to create a PDF.

9. Working tools

Feature	How it works
Find / Replace	`Ctrl`+`F` / `Ctrl`+`H` open a bar above the document. `F3` and `Shift`+`F3` jump between matches; `Esc` closes it. *Aa* matches case.
Outline	`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`O` or the outline button of the toolbar shows the headings on the left; click one to jump to it.
Your formatting is kept	Only the lines you change are rewritten when you save: list markers, `__bold__`, table alignment, line endings (CRLF/LF) and BOM stay as they were.
Changed outside	If another program modifies the open file, Gryphmark reloads it (or asks first if you have unsaved changes).
Crash recovery	Unsaved work is backed up every 20 seconds. If Gryphmark or Windows stops unexpectedly, the next start offers to recover it.
Spell check	*View → Spell check* underlines misspelled words (Windows dictionaries).
One window per file	Opening a .md while Gryphmark is running brings the existing window forward instead of starting a second copy. *File → New window* still opens another one.
Updates	Gryphmark checks once a day for a new version; *Help → Check for updates* does it on demand.
About	*Help → About Gryphmark* shows the version, author, license and credits. *Copy info* copies the version details, handy for reporting a problem.
Sample document	A sample that shows every feature in the three views. It opens on the first start and from *Help → Sample document*, and it is pinned at the top of *File → Open recent*; *Hide sample*, right below it, removes it from that list, and *Help → Show sample in Open recent* brings it back. It opens as an untitled copy, so the original is never overwritten, and it changes language together with the menus.

GitHub extras

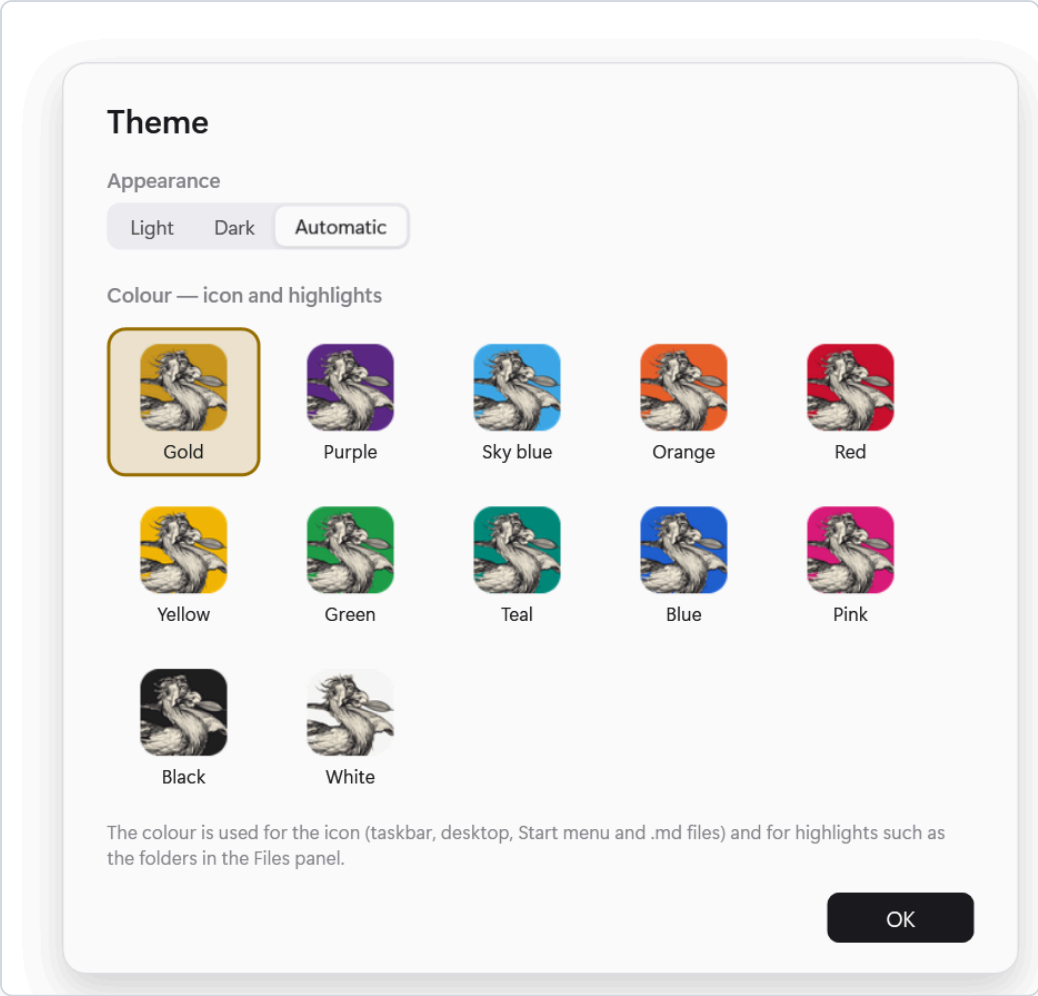
Also rendered exactly like GitHub: alerts (`> [!NOTE]` , `[!TIP]` , `[!IMPORTANT]` , `[!WARNING]` , `[!CAUTION]`), ```` ```mermaid ```` diagrams, math (`$E=mc^2$` and `$$ … $$`), footnotes (`[^1]`) and emoji shortcodes (`:rocket:`).

10. Language, theme and zoom

Language menu: English or Español. It changes the menus, the toolbar tooltips and dialogs immediately. The first time, Gryphmark follows the Windows language.

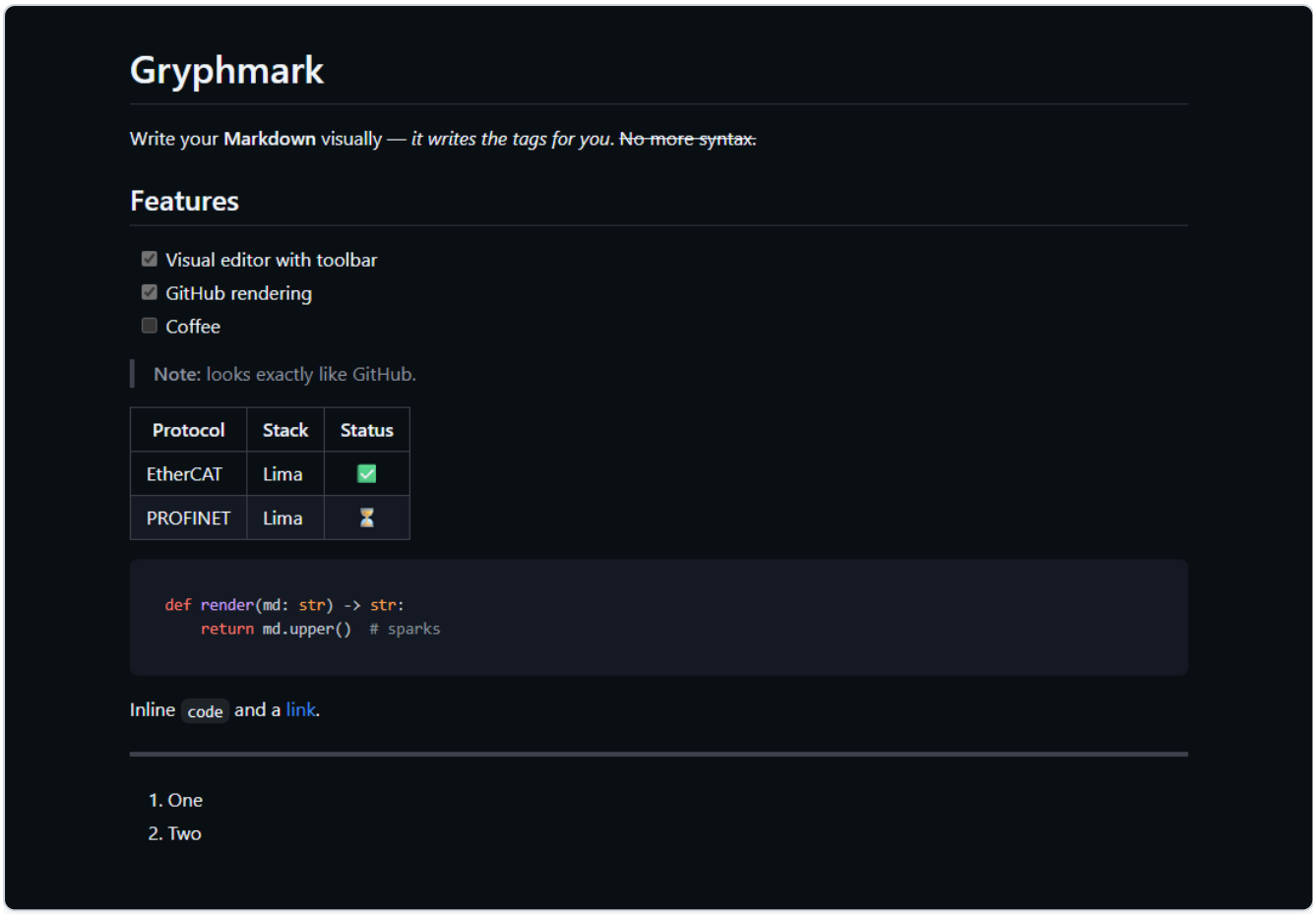
View → Theme… opens the theme window. **Appearance**: *Light*, *Dark* or *Automatic*, which follows Windows (Settings → Personalisation → Colours) and switches by itself when Windows does. **Colour**: a catalogue of twelve colours for the icon and the highlights. The chosen colour becomes the background of the icon everywhere — window, taskbar, desktop and Start-menu shortcuts, `.md` files — and colours the folders of

the Files panel, the check marks and the selected item. The default is dark gold. Shortcuts you made with an icon of your own are not changed.



The theme window.

Zoom with the **zoom bar** at the right of the status bar (−, slider, +; click the percentage to go back to 100 %), `Ctrl` + mouse wheel, `Ctrl`+`+`, `Ctrl`+`-` and `Ctrl`+`0`. Language, theme, mode, zoom and window size are remembered.



GitHub dark theme.

11. Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Action	Keys	Action
`Ctrl` + `N`	New	`Ctrl` + `B`	Bold
`Ctrl` + `O`	Open	`Ctrl` + `I`	Italic
`Ctrl` + `S`	Save	`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Y`	Undo / Redo
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S`	Save as	`Ctrl` + `1` / `2` / `3`	Visual / Source / GitHub
`Ctrl` + `P`	Print / PDF	`Ctrl` + `+` / `-` / `0`	Zoom
`Ctrl` + `W`	Close window	`F1`	This manual
`Ctrl` + `F` / `H`	Find / Replace	`F3` / `Shift` + `F3`	Next / previous match
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `O`	Outline	`Esc`	Close find bar
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `E`	Files panel	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `L`	Read only / Edit

12. Technical information

Item	Detail
Version	1.7.0
License	GNU GPL version 2 only (GPL-2.0-only) — free software, no warranty. Full text: `LICENSE.txt` in the program folder.
Platform	.NET 8 (WPF, self-contained) + Microsoft Edge WebView2
Editor	TOAST UI Editor 3.2 (MIT)
GitHub rendering	marked (GitHub Flavored Markdown), highlight.js, github-markdown-css (MIT)
Icon	Griffin from Martin Schongauer's engraving (c. 1485), The Metropolitan Museum of Art, CC0; quill added.
Settings	`%APPDATA%\Gryphmark\settings.json`
Source code	`src/` in the project folder; build with `build.ps1`.

> The visual editor normalises some details when it writes Markdown (for example, `*` lists become `-`). The text and the way GitHub displays it do not change.